4.2.1 Line segment

What do we call a line that is short and ends on both sides? That we call it as a line segment and name both of its ends with letters as shown in fig. 4.6.

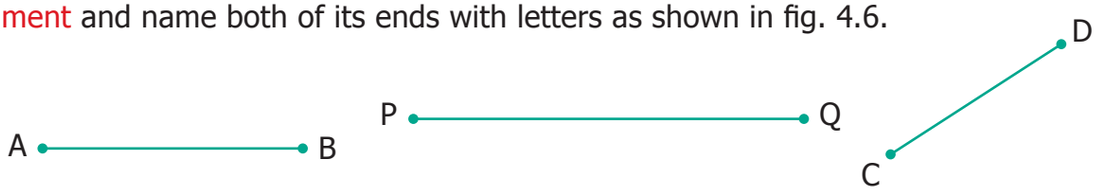


Fig. 4.6

We usually use CAPITAL LETTERS to denote the ends of the line segments. A line segment is denoted by $\overline{AB}$. What can we do with a line segment? We can measure its length. Given two line segments, we can compare their lengths and say which is shorter and which is longer.

Even if we measure length as a number, we get lots of line segments, each with a definite length. Using a ruler, we can draw the following line segments.

1 cm A B

2 cm A B

3 cm A B

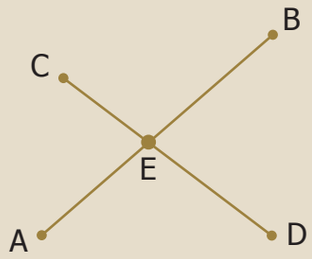
...

10 cm A B

What about a line segment of length 17 cm or 20 cm or 30 cm or 378 cm? Like, numbers never end, line segments get longer and longer forever!

TRY THIS

Name all the line segments.



4.2.2 Construction of line segment

Learn to measure line segments using the ruler.

Correct way of viewing the scale.

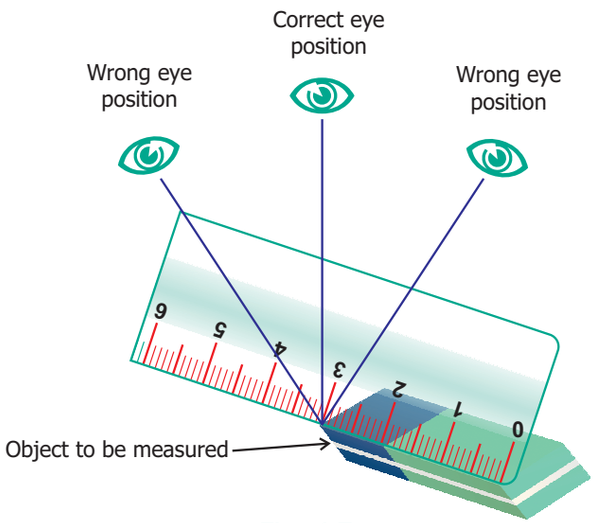


Fig. 4.7

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